

Student Support & Attendance

Learner guide | SWP-019 | School of School Social Work

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Student Support & Attendance. By the end of the course, you should be able to identify attendance barriers and coordinate supportive, non-punitive interventions.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Identify attendance barriers and coordinate supportive, non-punitive interventions.
- Apply the key ideas from Understanding absenteeism.
- Apply the key ideas from Student and family engagement.
- Apply the key ideas from Intervention and monitoring.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Understanding absenteeism	attendance patterns, barriers, equity, safeguarding, and early warning data	10 to 15 minutes
2. Student and family engagement	assessment, strengths, home-school partnership, and culturally responsive communication	10 to 15 minutes
3. Intervention and monitoring	individual plans, referrals, attendance review, and escalation pathways	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Understanding absenteeism

This module focuses on attendance patterns, barriers, equity, safeguarding, and early warning data. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Attendance patterns
- Barriers
- Equity
- Safeguarding
- Early warning data

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of understanding absenteeism in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of attendance patterns, barriers, equity, safeguarding, and early warning data. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through understanding absenteeism safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Student and family engagement

This module focuses on assessment, strengths, home-school partnership, and culturally responsive communication. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Assessment
- Strengths
- Home-school partnership
- Culturally responsive communication

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of student and family engagement in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of assessment, strengths, home-school partnership, and culturally responsive communication. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through student and family engagement safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Intervention and monitoring

This module focuses on individual plans, referrals, attendance review, and escalation pathways. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Individual plans
- Referrals
- Attendance review
- Escalation pathways

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of intervention and monitoring in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of individual plans, referrals, attendance review, and escalation pathways. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through intervention and monitoring safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: barriers.
- Review the distinction between: early intervention.
- Review the distinction between: safeguarding.
- Review the distinction between: monitoring.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.